MONTHLY UPDATE

Strategies, plans and policies: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *38 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.*

ALGERIA · BOTSWANA · BURKINA FASO · BURUNDI · CAMEROON · CAPE VERDE · CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC · CHAD · COMOROS · COTE D'IVOIRE · DJIBOUTI · DR CONGO · EGYPT · EQUATORIAL GUINEA · ERITREA · ETHIOPIA · GABON · GAMBIA · GHANA · GUINEA-BISSAU · KENYA · LIBERIA · MADAGASCAR · MAURITANIA · MAURITIUS · MOZAMBIQUE · NIGERIA · SENEGAL · SEYCHELLES · SIERRA LEONE · SOUTH AFRICA · SOUTH SUDAN · SUDAN · TOGO · TUNISIA · UGANDA · ZAMBIA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

On 8 September state media described the digital transformation as resting on data-protection and cybersecurity laws and on local infrastructure including national data centres, and as aimed at transparency in public management and at combating administrative malpractice; it gives no target, budget or completion date. In September the high commission trained the sectors' information-systems managers to deploy and operate the mechanism for verifying electronic documents issued through the national portal, under a presidential instruction of 12 July to widen the portal's uses. No count of sectors, documents or verifications is published.

Botswana

The data policy is being turned into something implementable. A five-day data governance capacity-building and stakeholder engagement was held from 7 to 11 September to translate the national data policy's principles and direction into a national data strategy, with continental and European support. No draft strategy or adoption date is published.

The national digital transformation strategy has a launch date. President Duma Boko told the UN Economic Commission for Africa in New York that SmartBots would be formally launched in November, with the commission sought as a continuing partner; no budget or targets are published.

Burkina Faso

The other plan in hand is being redrawn rather than written: the authorities are revising the national plan for the digital development of the territory to a 2030 horizon, against an international estimate putting about 70 per cent of the population off the internet in 2024. No revised text, timetable or cost is published.

Burundi

The draft law on access to public information, adopted in Council of Ministers on 10 June, was adopted by the Senate on 29 September 2026. Promulgation is not on record and no text is published.

Cameroon

The state has commissioned a plan to digitise the system through which it buys everything else. A six-month assignment to produce a national master plan for the public-procurement information system went to a consulting grouping for FCFA 241.36 million including tax, funded under a development bank public finance governance project, to audit existing systems, analyse information exchange between actors and propose digitisation scenarios and an implementation programme. It builds on an e-procurement system already in place, which an interministerial review recommended accelerating in June 2025 and for which no throughput or adoption figure is published, against 8,143 programmed contracts worth FCFA 1,745.9 billion recorded by the ministry for 2025.

Cape Verde

On 10 September the prime minister named state modernisation and digital transformation among the government's priorities for the new phase of the United Nations partnership, with no framework document or envelope attached. On 16 September a territorial programme for Maio was launched with internet-access, digital-economy and training projects and free internet points in three localities, Fogo to follow; no budget is stated.

Central African Republic

The digital development agency's own presentation establishes its footing: it was created by law in June 2023 as a public establishment with a mandate to implement the national digital strategy. No budget, staffing or activity report is held.

Chad

The strategy's money has started to arrive, slowly: US$790.5m of the US$20.5bn pledged at Abu Dhabi, 3.9%, is now signed across seventeen companies. The ministry and the United Nations regional commission validated the national data governance strategy at a workshop in N'Djamena, on seven pillars.

Comoros

In September the agency turned to measuring where it stands. It and UNDP signed a memorandum on 16 September to run a national digital readiness assessment covering skills, connectivity, public services, regulation and the digital economy across the three islands, presented as a way to target the next investments under the 2028 strategy. No timetable or publication date is given.

Cote d'Ivoire

Closing the national workshop on prioritising public digital services on 4 September, the digital transition minister argued for unified governance through a relaunched National Digital Council placed under the Prime Minister, presenting it as a condition of the state's digital transformation, against a paperless state by 2030. It is an argument for a relaunch: no decree, membership or first meeting is held.

The development plan's digital component was then costed for investors: on 15 September the minister set out six opportunities worth 541.3 billion FCFA to the private sector, against a target of lifting the digital economy to 15 per cent of GDP by 2030. The digital acceleration project shortlisted six firms or consortia to support implementation of the country's digital and artificial intelligence compact, in a results notice published on 30 September; the compact's own text is not held.

Djibouti

The interoperability framework acquired a statement of intent for the first time since it was published in 2022. The Council of Ministers' 2026 work programme of 1 September names paperless services and interoperability among the state-modernisation priorities. Nothing in it evidences the framework in use, and no system, timetable or budget is attached — so what has changed is that the government has said the word, not that anything is interoperable.

DR Congo

Two World Bank-supported studies on infrastructure sharing, national roaming, local-loop unbundling and telecom taxation were presented in Kinshasa on 9 September, recommending lower duties on equipment and new sites and a central infrastructure database. No government decision on them is recorded.

Egypt

The communications minister said on 22 September that a national data-centre strategy would be launched by the end of 2026, having told a cabinet meeting on 20 September that it is being drawn up with other ministries to expand data-centre capacity inside Egypt; no draft text is held. On 9 September he put the Digital Egypt platform at about 245 live services, with more than 400 targeted by 2030, against the over 270 by end-2026 and about 450 by 2030 he set out in July.

Equatorial Guinea

Two plans and no strategy is still the position. The transport ministry's half-year plan sets the country's first published broadband target, 85 per cent coverage through 34 new towers by the end of 2026, and a World Bank team opened a four-day session in Malabo in early September to finalise a national digital economy strategy — on a diagnostic that found no interoperability framework and no digital skills data held.

Eritrea

The month adds the sector's policy furniture rather than a new instrument. The one sector-specific policy named anywhere is for education: an education profile last modified on 2 September records a National Policy for ICT in Education, a 2018-2022 sector plan aiming at technology infrastructure and e-learning, and an initiative the ministry launched in January 2005, and the sector plan itself states that incorporating technology remains difficult for want of facilities, equipment and teacher training. The profile carrying it is a legacy platform its publisher states is no longer updated. No national digital or ICT strategy appears at any date, so the sector is governed by three texts from 1998 and 2003 that the repository does not hold.

Ethiopia

A third National Financial Inclusion Strategy, for 2026 to 2030, was launched with an assessment of its predecessor: adult account ownership reached 66 per cent in 2025 against a 70 per cent target, and the assessment finds a 60 per cent implementation deficit in digital-fraud countermeasures. Neither document is held.

Gabon

The new infrastructure and cybersecurity directorate has a head. The Council of Ministers of 18 September named Anicet Claude Andjouat director general of the directorate whose creation it approved in December 2025, whose spectrum, infrastructure and cybersecurity missions overlap those the national digital infrastructure and frequencies agency claims. No text dividing the two mandates is published.

Gambia

The higher education ministry validated a draft science, technology and innovation policy for 2027 to 2035 and its accompanying bill at a national workshop, reported on 3 September. An evaluation of the 2015-2024 policy found that none of its objectives were met.

Ghana

The communications minister told a UNESCO ministerial forum that government has begun implementing measures against the gaps a UNESCO readiness assessment found in digital infrastructure, AI capacity and cybersecurity resilience, reported on 15 September. No procurement, site or completion date is published for the investment figures attached to the plan. The communications minister announced a centralised technical review of every AI system bought by a public institution, scoped by the national information technology agency against interoperability, data-protection, cybersecurity and skills-transfer requirements; no directive or start date is published.

Guinea-Bissau

The strategy's implementation plan is in preparation with a United Nations university unit. On 9 September UNU-EGOV presented a delegation from the territorial-administration ministry with the project document for implementing the national digital transformation strategy, meant to set priorities, governance structures, partners and resources; no adoption date is published.

Kenya

Government communication was centralised. The broadcasting principal secretary described a newly adopted National Communication Policy built on 'One Government, One Voice', with a National Communication Centre to collate, validate and release state information; the final text is dated 22 January 2026. No budget or staffing for the centre is published.

Liberia

The financial inclusion strategy reached validation. The central bank's draft went through a two-day validation and will be revised, with participants naming the identification registry, business registration and credit reference systems as what it depends on; no launch date is set.

Madagascar

Madagascar scores 9 of 16 points against the Open Government Partnership's 12-point eligibility threshold as it seeks to rejoin the body it first joined in December 2016.

Mauritania

On 16 September the Council of Ministers took a statement proposing a national framework on minors' access to social media: an access threshold at 16, recommendation algorithms, infinite scroll and autoplay off by default for minors, no advertising targeted at them, and a reporting and support mechanism for children harmed online. It is a proposal; no draft text or date is published.

Mauritius

Cabinet approved Mauritius Vision 2050 on 11 September, targeting a US$50bn economy with digital among seven strategic sectors; the document is not published.

Mozambique

The Digital Transformation Operational Plan 2026-2029 was under appraisal at the technical commission's second session on 21 September, to be harmonised and costed within two to three months. It names an interoperability portal, a payments platform for state services, a government cloud and a government data centre, and the state administration minister told the session that data produced by the public administration must belong to the State.

The plan in force is the Strategic Plan for the Information Society 2019-2028: a civil-society review published on 22 September cites it as Resolution 52/2019 and finds its execution hampered by limited consolidated public reporting and dependence on donor cycles.

The communications regulator called on 23 September for consultants to diagnose the postal market and draft a postal sector transformation strategy, roadmap and action plan within six months, with expressions of interest due on 9 October. A proposed Internet for All strategy with targets to 2030 was presented in Maputo, where only 15% of the population was said to afford mobile data.

Nigeria

The IT agency issued a cloud package of four frameworks headed by a National Cloud Computing Guideline. The public service reform bureau's director general said on 30 September that the President has approved renewal of the National Strategy on Public Service Reforms, the revision to take in policies on artificial intelligence and blockchain in the public service; neither the approval date nor the new text is given.

Senegal

The roadmap acquired a shape and a hole in the same statement. Presented at an international forum on 4 September, the New Deal Technologique is 54 projects across 12 programmes at US$2bn over ten years, of which US$700m is unallocated. The figures are the government's own and no project list, allocation schedule or financing plan for the unallocated third accompanies them, so what is established is the size of the programme and the size of the gap in it. The prime minister's general policy statement of 8 September refocused the programme on a sovereign cloud for the state's sensitive data and an accelerated sectoral AI strategy, narrowing selection to initiatives that are feasible, financed and able to produce measurable results.

The new prime minister's general policy declaration of 8 September kept the New Deal technologique as the framework and named a sovereign cloud to host sensitive state data on national soil, with a stated change of method: projects must now show feasibility, financing and demonstrated impact before they proceed. No project list or costing accompanies it.

The digital ministry validated its draft blueprint for creating value from data at a workshop on 21 and 22 September, run with Smart Africa's data-governance programme and GIZ; Senegal is a pilot with Kenya and Lesotho, and no finalisation date was given.

The ministry called on 24 September for firms to study the interoperability platform's infrastructure needs, to grow a start-small X-Road set-up into a multisite architecture across national and sectoral data centres.

Seychelles

Cabinet approved a Digital Economic Transformation Forum on 9 September to agree a national digital architecture and pilots, the nearest thing to a plan the repository holds. A commission of inquiry into the border management service agreement between the state and its border-security supplier opened on 2 September 2026, with former ministers testifying; the supplier's system runs the country's digital border control, including the electronic travel authorisation.

Sierra Leone

A data governance framework was named as in development for the first time. Meeting United Nations agencies on 5 September, the communications minister named the framework alongside the government data centre at the telecommunications authority tower and a redundancy site at State House. No draft, scope, adoption route or timetable is published for the framework, and the redundancy site appears here with no capacity or commissioning date.

The open source policy Cabinet approved in July was presented by the communications minister at a UNICEF showcase on the UNGA81 sidelines as the answer to duplicated government systems, proprietary-technology costs and vendor lock-in. Its text is still not published.

South Africa

On 4 September the regulator gazetted two market inquiries. The first covers the impact of over-the-top services on telecommunications, broadcasting and postal licensees; the regulator named Netflix and WhatsApp, saying such services have disrupted regulated linear broadcasting's competition for audiences and revenue. The second covers the affordability of voice and broadband for low-income households, rural communities, youth and informal-sector workers. Each runs in four phases. Neither sets a date for findings or commits the regulator to act on them. The regulator withdrew both notices of its inquiry into over-the-top services on 30 September, to be republished at a later date. The universal service agency said the minister has approved the fund's manual, after a draft was withdrawn in November 2025 and reissued for comment in February 2026. The deputy minister said the redrafted policy is due for ministerial input by the end of November 2026 and at cabinet by the end of 2026/27. The universal service agency gazetted a discussion document on the 2010 determination, with three options and a lean to targeted revision, comments closing 30 October 2026. The consultation, reported 10 October 2026, creates no new funding, subsidy or licensing obligation.

South Sudan

Officials took part in a three-day data governance workshop hosted by the African Union Commission, its development agency and partners with the ICT ministry, reported on 15 September, to set a roadmap for implementing the continental data policy framework. No national policy, law or timetable has followed.

Sudan

A banker's review published on 21 September finds no implementation programmes, budgets or indicators attached to the central bank's 2026-2030 strategic plan. The plan carries 150 initiatives, and its digital axis commits to a banking disaster-recovery centre, a wider data-centre network and a hybrid cloud project.

Togo

On 21 September the education ministry presented a drafted national policy on artificial intelligence in technical and vocational training to a six-country regional workshop, which is to return an enriched version by its close on 24 September; the draft is not published. The finance ministry published a revenue strategy for 2027 to 2031 that puts 57.1% of its cost into digital transformation, electronic invoicing and AI-assisted risk analysis among it. The social protection programme's first component is paying more than 700,000 people by mobile money on CFA 3.5bn of initial funding. The figure is the target identified, not households paid.

Tunisia

Tunisia's Geneva mission said on 21 September that UNCTAD is supporting the trade ministry in drafting a national e-commerce strategy, with planning meetings held from 31 March to 2 April 2026; no adoption date is stated. The health and communication technologies ministers signed a National Health Pact on 1 October, with sovereign governance of health data and modernised digital platforms among its six axes; its text and budget are not held. The communications minister said on 9 October 2026 that the postal operator has a 2026-2030 strategy built on digital transformation, with artificial intelligence and digital identity to be integrated into the postal system, and a resource-planning system already being introduced in phases.

Uganda

The revenue authority began implementing a compliance risk management strategy for 2026/27 that uses taxpayer information, business transactions and sector trends to find compliance gaps. The science, technology and innovation minister said a national artificial intelligence strategy is under development, reported on 10 September.

Zambia

The second term opened on a new blueprint. The state ICT institute endorsed the Grow Zambia Agenda 2026-2031 for its eight digital-infrastructure targets and said it is building a real-time Cabinet dashboard to monitor it; the targets themselves are not published.

The technology and youth ministries are developing a framework for local content creators to earn from digital platforms, engaging Meta, TikTok and Google and compiling a national database of creators, after the President made it a priority at the opening of the 14th National Assembly.

Zimbabwe

The ICT minister said on 18 September 2026 that a Postal and Courier Services Policy is being drafted. No draft or date is published. The ICT minister told the regulator to consider a unit to oversee operators' commercial arrangements and enforce active infrastructure sharing.

On World Post Day the ICT minister gave her ministry, the regulator and the postal operator 90 days to produce a costed Postal and Courier Sector Transformation Implementation Plan to 2030, with quarterly progress reports.

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